

News Weekly

Sherpa, thought to have died on Mount Everest, miraculously found

A Nepali climbing guide thought to have died on Mount Everest was found crawling down to Base Camp six days after he was last seen alive. Dawa Sherpa was last seen above Camp 3, around 7,500m, while descending after summiting. Despite slim survival hopes due to thin air, a cleaning crew found him on Thursday with frostbite on his hands but in good health, slowly sliding down. "Dawa managed to survive against all odds for days. It's nothing short of a miracle," said Pemba Sherpa of 8K Expeditions. Five people have died this climbing season, including three Nepalis involved in Everest preparations, according to AFP. More than 1,000 reached the summit this season, the busiest on record. Dawa Sherpa, also known as Hillary Dawa Sherpa, was found "slowly sliding through" the Khumbu Icefall toward Base Camp. "As far as I know, no one has survived alone at that altitude on Everest so far. This is a miracle," said Pemba Sherpa. Dawa Sherpa is "awake and undergoing treatment," according to Dr. Nishant Dhakal of Kathmandu's HAMS Hospital. "He recognised me ... is good and speaks," his daughter Mbendo Lhamo Sherpa told Reuters. Before he was found, his wife had offered last rite prayers for his soul.



Flesh-eating New World screwworm found in Texas calf poses a significant threat to food production, according to the USDA.

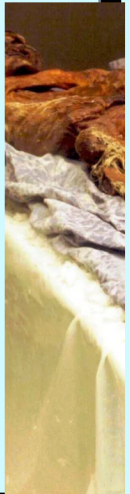
A case of flesh-eating New World screwworm has been found in South Texas, marking the first detection in US livestock in decades, according to the USDA. While not a food safety issue, an infestation could significantly impact food production costs, potentially raising beef prices. The USDA confirmed the presence in a 3-week-old calf and has initiated containment measures, including quarantines and the release of sterile flies to control the spread.

The New World screwworm, previously eradicated in the US, poses a threat to livestock, wildlife, and pets, as its larvae feed on the tissue of warm-blooded animals. Although human infections are rare, they can be fatal. The current risk to human health is low, but livestock workers and outdoor enthusiasts are advised to remain vigilant against potential infections. Emergency treatments for animal infestations are being expedited to South Texas. (Source: CBS)



Yeast found in the Ötzi the iceman used to make sourdough bread

Yeast found in the gut of Ötzi the Iceman, a frozen mummy from over 5,300 years ago, has been used to make sourdough bread. Ötzi, killed by an arrow in the Alps, was discovered in 1991. His well-preserved remains, kept at minus six degrees Celsius, provide insights into ancient human life. Recent research in the *Microbiome* journal revealed active ancient and modern microbes in his body. "We didn't expect to find yeast," said Mohamed Sarhan from Eurac Research. The yeast is cold-adapted and active. Four types of yeast were discovered in Ötzi's gut, skin, and water, likely entering his body after death. Genetic analysis showed minimal DNA damage. The researchers reproduced the yeast in a fridge and, after three months, successfully made sourdough bread. Sarhan joked about brewing beer with the yeast, which is being considered. The study also noted the yeast's potential in breaking down phenol, used on Ötzi's body to prevent fungus. (Source: CBS)



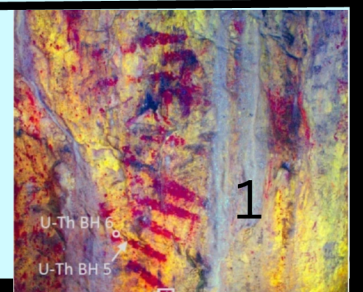
United Airlines flight diverted back to Newark due to suspicious Bluetooth device name

A United Airlines flight took off from Newark heading for Spain, but decided to pull a dramatic U-turn mid-air due to a cheeky security threat. The flight to Palma de Mallorca, which took off at 6 p.m., made its way back to Newark at 9:37 p.m. with 190 passengers and 12 crew members. The plot twist? A Bluetooth device with a spicy name—rumored to be "bomb"! The crew asked everyone to switch off their Bluetooth gadgets, but some rebels didn't comply. After chatting with HQ, the plane made its about-face. Passengers endured a security check dance with Port Authority police and TSA before catching a replacement flight that zoomed off early Sunday morning. This escapade adds to United Airlines' recent streak of nerve-wracking security sagas. (Source: ABC News)



Red stripes in Welsh cave declared Britain's oldest art after being dismissed as natural phenomenon

Red stripes on a rock in Wales, once dismissed as a natural phenomenon, have now been recognized as the oldest prehistoric art in Britain and northwestern Europe. Created by human hands approximately 17,100 years ago, these red-pigmented stripes were the focus of renewed investigation by an international team at Bacon Hole, a cave located near Mumbles in South Wales. Initially identified as art in 1912 by Professor William Sollas and Henri Breuil, they were later believed to be natural mineral deposits. Archaeologist George Harold Nash, who led the research team, confirmed their human origin. Published in the journal *"Quaternary"*, the study concluded that the lines were intentionally created by humans, rather than being a product of natural processes. This finding reclassifies the stripes as the oldest known cave art in the region. Nash expressed his enthusiasm about the discovery, emphasizing the extraordinary experience of uncovering this previously overlooked artwork. Modern dating techniques further validated the authenticity of the stripes, indicating a deliberate and structured pattern.

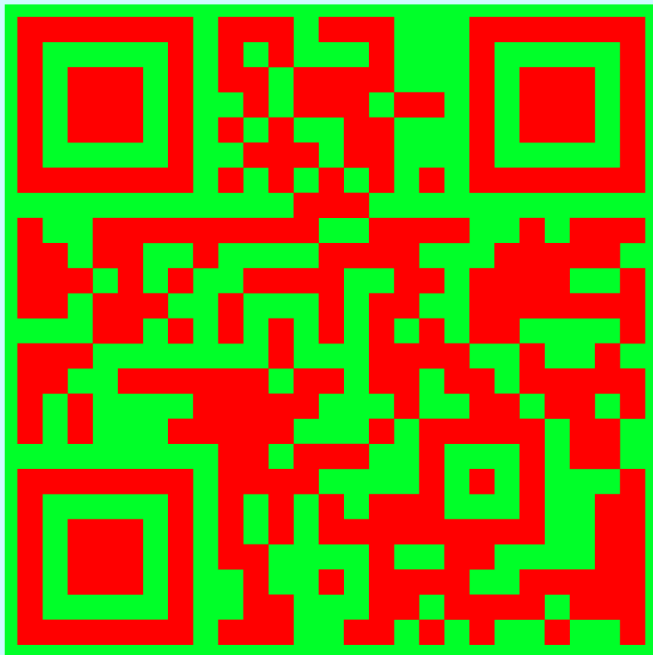


Atom jokes

Are you sure you lost an electron?

I'm positive!

Metazooa



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Rosemary Potatoes

- Ingredients
- 1 1/2 pounds small red or white-skinned potatoes (or a mixture)
- 1/8 cup good olive oil
- 3/4 teaspoon kosher salt
- 1/2 teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
- 1 tablespoons minced garlic (3 cloves)
- 2 tablespoons minced fresh rosemary leaves
- Preheat the oven to 400 degrees F.
- Cut the potatoes in half or quarters and place in a bowl with the olive oil, salt, pepper, garlic and rosemary; toss until the potatoes are well coated. Dump the potatoes on a baking sheet and spread out into 1 layer; roast in the oven for at least 1 hour, or until browned and crisp. Flip twice with a spatula during cooking to ensure even browning.
- Remove the potatoes from the oven, season to taste, and serve

